Pokémon DECKBUILDING GAME

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Special Thanks:

Berserk Games for making the amazing tool that is Tabletop Simulator
The Pokémon Company for creating such the memorable and enduring world that Pokémon has become

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RULEBOOK

Overview

In the Pokémon Deckbuilding Game, you take on the role of Ash, Brock, Misty, or one of five other iconic characters from the Pokémon universe in hopes of becoming a true Pokémon Master. While you start your adventure with just your starter Pokémon or Item and some basic moves to aid you, as the game progresses you will add new and more powerful cards to your deck. In the end, the player with the most XP will be declared the very best, like no one ever was!

Contents

247 Game Cards
- 24 Tackle Starter Cards
- 12 Energy Removal Starter Cards
- 8 Unique Trainer Starter Cards
- 16 Potion Cards
- 20 Poison Cards
- 8 Challenge Cards
- 50 Evolved Pokémon Cards
- 109 Main Deck Cards

8 Oversized Trainer Cards

1 Rulebook

Setup For Your First Game

1. Trainer Cards and Starting Decks

Each player is dealt a random Trainer Card from among the following: Ash, Brock, Misty, Nurse Joy, Officer Jenny, Bill, Gary, and Professor Oak.

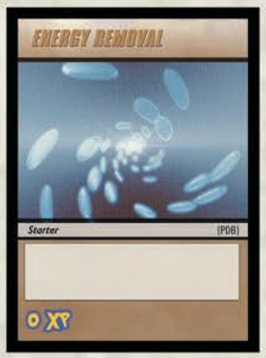
Each Trainer has a starting card that is unique to that Trainer. Each Trainer begins with a starting deck of their unique starting card, Six Tackle cards, and Three Energy Removal cards. Shuffling these cards together gives each player a starting deck of exactly 10 cards. You will use your Tackle cards to buy more powerful cards to add to your deck, improving it as the game goes on. Energy Removal cards represent fatigue throughout your travels. They typically don't do anything for you when drawn or played, so it's best to get rid of them as soon as possible (more on how to do that later).

x6

x3

Types of Cards

Card Type



XP Value

Trainer **Starter**

Cost

XP Value

Abilities

Challenge **Poison** **Pokémon** **Evolved Pokémon**

Cost

Card Name

Item **TM / HM** **Encounter**

The different primary card types in the game are: Starter, Pokémon, Item, TM / HM, Encounter, and Challenge. Poison cards have no card type.

2. The Main Deck

Most of the cards that you will add to your deck as the game progresses come from the Main Deck.

None of the following cards or card types should ever be placed into the Main Deck:

> Challenge, Evolved Pokemon, Energy Removal, Poison, Potion, Tackle, the unique Starting Cards, or the oversized Trainer cards.

The Main Deck is made up of every other card in the game.
Shuffle the Main Deck and place it in the middle of the table.

3. The Challenge Stack

There are eight different Challenge cards available to use each game. These cards represent Gym Battles and their corresponding Badges.

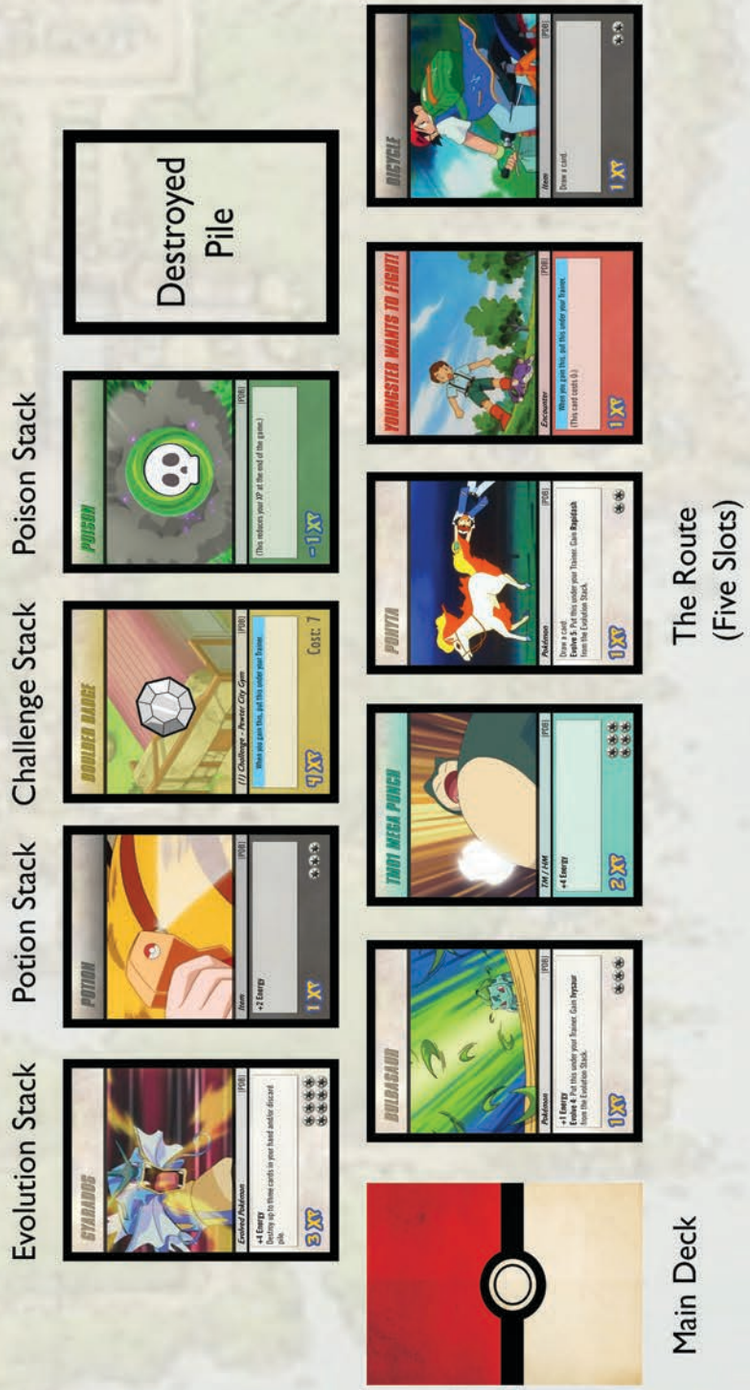
The Challenge cards are numbered from 1 to 8. Place them face down and in order, with number 8 on the bottom and number 1 on the top. Then flip the top card face up (Boulder Badge should be showing).

4. The Route

After shuffling the Main Deck, place the top five cards from the Main Deck into the Route. There is no board necessary to play this game; just reserve space for each card.

Next, for each player, place four Potions and five Poisons into their respective Stacks. Then place these stacks and the Challenge Stack above the Route. Then place the Evolution Stack next to the Main Deck, face-up.

Potions and Challenge cards are always available to be bought or gained during your turn (while cards remain in their stacks). Poisons are never bought, they are gained only through unfriendly effects. The Main Deck and the four stacks of cards on the end are not part of the Route.



Gameplay

Randomly determine a player to go first, unless somene is playing as Gary. Gary always goes first (he's always a step ahead). Each player begins by shuffling their deck and drawing five cards. Players take turns in clockwise order.

Each turn, you may buy cards from the Route, Potion cards, and/or the top card of the Challenge Stack to improve your deck and/or gain XP. Cards you buy or gain are always immediately placed into your discard pile unless you are instructed otherwise. Discard piles are always face up. Soon they'll be shuffled into your deck, and then you'll be drawing these newer, more powerful cards into your hand so you can play them. Buying powerful cards builds up the effectiveness of your deck. That's why it's called a "deckbuilding game".

You can buy any number of available cards with combined cost less than or equal to the amount of Energy you have for the turn. For example, your Tackle cards each give you +1 Energy. If you draw four of them and no other cards with any Energy bonuses, your total Energy for the turn is 4. You can buy a single card with cost 2, 3, or 4, or even two cards each with cost 2, assuming these options are available. Potion cards are (usually) available if the cards in the Route are too expensive, and you may buy more than one during your turn if you wish. You do not have to play all of your cards each turn and you may choose to not buy any cards if you wish.

Energy Removal and Poison cards provide no Energy. Since they weaken your draws and your deck, you should try to destroy them as soon as possible. You may play them if you wish, but they (generally) have no effect when played. They are not discarded until the end of your turn when you discard all cards you have played and any cards that you have kept in your hand.

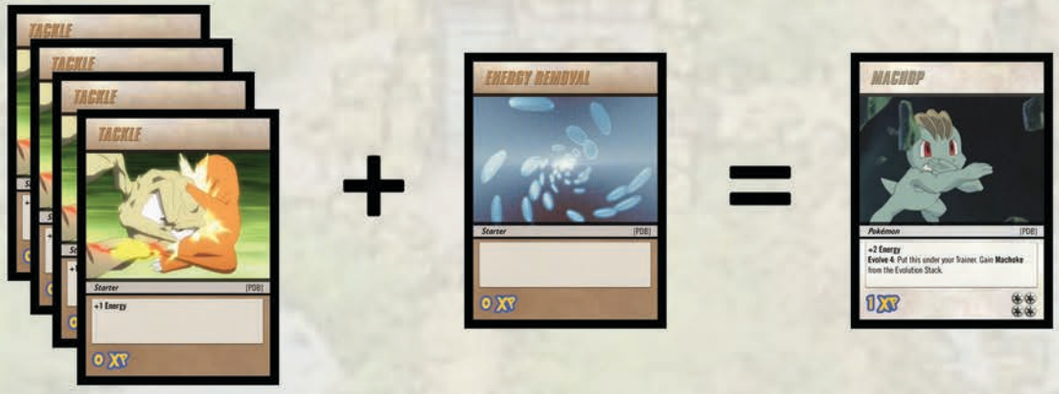
Order of Playing Your Cards

On your turn, you get to play the cards in your hand one at a time. When you play a card, its game text resolves immediately. When you have played all the cards you wish to play at that time, total up the Energy you have accumulated and buy what you wish to buy from the Route or the face up stacks. You do not have to play all of the cards in your hand before you start making purchases if you don't wish to. You may play and buy additional cards even after making purchases.

Ending Your Turn

1. Announce that you are ending your turn.
2. Place any cards remaining in your hand into your discard pile.
3. Resolve any "at the end of your turn" effects.
4. Place all the cards you played into your discard pile. Any unspent Energy is lost.
5. Fill each empty slot in the Route with a card from the top of the Main Deck.
6. If the top card of the Challenge Stack is face down, flip it face up.
7. Draw your new hand (typically five cards).
8. The next player starts their turn and resolves any new Encounter Attacks in the order of their choosing.

Sample Turn Sequence



After shuffling up your starting cards, you draw a hand of four Tackles and one Energy Removal for your first turn. You may play the four Tackles for a total of 4 Energy, which is enough to buy Machop from the Route. After buying it, you put it into your discard pile.

End of Game

The game ends immediately when either of the following conditions is met:

- You are unable to flip up a new Challenge card in the Challenge Stack
- You are unable to refill all five slots of the Route

Then, players total up the XP of all their cards. Be sure to include cards that are under your Trainer. Poison cards you own at the end of the game will subtract XP from your total.

The player with the highest XP total is declared the Pokémon Master! In case of a tie, the player with more Challenge cards wins. If still tied, the player with more Pokémon wins.

After a winner has been determined, all players will need to take apart their decks, placing all of the cards back into their proper stacks.

Additional Rules

Attacks and Defenses

Some cards allow you to make an Attack against the other players in the game. Some Attacks will have you choose an opponent, while others will affect all opponents. When you play a card with an Attack ability, each chosen player has an opportunity to avoid the Attack with a card that has a Defense ability. A player using a Defense card's ability negates the Attack only for that defending player. A player may only use one Defense per Attack. Any chosen players who don't avoid the Attack are then affected by the Attack card's ability.

Encounters

Encounters represent battles, ploys by Team Rocket, or other various traps and events that one may come across. Unless otherwise stated, Encounter Attacks only target the player who's turn it is, and may be defended against with a Defense card.

Gaining Cards

When a card tells you to gain a particular card or a card of your choice, that card is taken and immediately placed in your discard pile, unless otherwise directed by the card. If a card tells you to gain a card with a specific name, card type, or cost and there are none available, you simply don't gain the card.

Resolving Card Abilities

If a card's ability affects multiple players, resolve that ability for each affected player in clockwise order, starting from the player who played the ability. When you play a card that triggers another effect, fully resolve the card you are playing before resolving any secondary effects triggered by your card play.

Shuffling Your Deck

You don't reshuffle your discard pile into your deck as soon as you run out of cards. However, if at any point during the game if there are no cards in your deck and you need to draw, discard, or reveal a card from your deck, immediately reshuffle your discard pile, and it becomes your new deck. Effects that say to 'look at' cards from the top of your deck *do not* cause a reshuffle.

Destroying Cards

Some cards have an ability that allows you to destroy a card from your hand, your deck, your discard pile, or even the Route. When you destroy a card, place it into the Destroyed Pile, removing it from the game.

You will often get to choose which of your cards to destroy. Destroying Energy Removal and Poison cards will improve your deck greatly! If Potion and Poison cards are destroyed, they do not go back to their respective stacks.

Evolving Pokémon

Some Pokémon have an optional ability that allows them to Evolve. To Evolve a Pokémon, you must control it and it must be in play, typically by having played it that turn. At any point during the Main Phase of your turn (after any "At the start of your turn" triggers but before ending your turn), you may pay the amount of Energy listed next to the word Evolve. Following the text on the card, place it under your Trainer, search the Evolution Stack for the card specified, then gain that card.

FAQ

When a Pokémon Evolves, any lingering or on-going effects immediately stop and/or do not resolve.

For example, playing Abra from your discard pile and then Evolving into Kadabra results in Abra staying under your Trainer and Kadabra going to the discard pile.

If a card tells you to gain a card and it is not possible to do so, you do not gain that card.

For example, some Encounters have highlighted text that says "This can't be bought or gained." If you play Mew and the top card of the Main Deck was an Encounter with that text, put that Encounter back on top of the Main Deck instead of gaining it.

Any time a card references discarding a card, unless otherwise specified, it implies discarding from that player's hand.

Any time a player searches their deck for any reason, they must shuffle their deck afterwards.

A player searching their deck for a card with a specific description (name, type, cost, etc.) can fail to find a card even if one exists.

Attempting to search an empty deck does not cause a reshuffle.